

Ioannis Kleftogiannis

Frontend Engineer — React & TypeScript Specialist

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SUMMARY

Frontend engineer with 4 years of production experience, primarily in fintech and public-sector platforms. Built and maintained core UI for two consumer payment products under PCI DSS constraints at OKTO, and currently drive most of the day-to-day frontend implementation on a government communications platform at Cognito, working under a tech lead who splits his focus across DevOps and full-stack work. Comfortable owning architecture decisions, not just executing tickets — from state management and performance to component design and delivery. Outside client work, designed and shipped a solo full-stack SaaS product (auth, billing, hosting, the works) end-to-end, and keeps up with frontend tooling by experimenting with local LLMs and AI coding agents in personal projects.

EXPERIENCE

Frontend Developer · Cognito

Jun 2025 – Present

Athens, Greece (Hybrid)

- Primary frontend contributor on Gov.gr Messenger, a public-sector communications platform, working alongside a full-stack tech lead who focuses mainly on DevOps and task coordination.
- Own most frontend implementation decisions in practice — component architecture, design execution, and delivery — with the tech lead available for direction but not hands-on in the frontend code day-to-day.
- Built training materials and internal documentation (web, mobile, and admin walkthroughs) used to onboard stakeholders and other engineers.

Frontend Developer · OKTO (Fintech, Payments)

Jul 2023 – Apr 2025

Athens, Greece

- Built and maintained core UI for OKTO.Direct and OKTO.Cash, two consumer-facing payment products, using React and TypeScript.
- Owned state management for multi-step transaction flows (Redux + Context API), keeping state consistent across screens during high-frequency user actions.
- Cut first-meaningful-render time through lazy loading and memoization on the highest-traffic screens.
- Worked directly with backend engineers to keep the frontend compliant with PCI DSS requirements around handling sensitive financial data.
- Mentored closely by senior engineers on React/TypeScript patterns early on; ramped up enough to start supporting newer hires by the end of the role.

Programmer · ARHS Developments Hellas

Aug 2022 – Mar 2023

Athens, Greece

- Built desktop and native mobile applications (React, React Native) for a digital health platform used by doctors and patients to manage prescriptions (ESCEN / Nowomed).
- Worked with stakeholders to translate clinical workflow requirements into usable interface designs.
- Integrated third-party tools and components, with a focus on usability and performance across both platforms.

Junior Developer · Solutionist

Apr 2022 – Jun 2022

Athens, Greece

- First professional development role — built full-stack features (desktop and mobile) across a climate data visualization tool and a gaming administration platform.
- Got hands-on with the basics of responsive design, performance, and working directly with non-engineering stakeholders on requirements.

INDEPENDENT PROJECT

Independent Developer · OurChapter (solo project)

Nov 2025 – Feb 2026

- Designed and built OurChapter solo, end-to-end: a Next.js app letting people create personalized digital pages (photos, stories, an unlock-gate quiz mechanic) for partners and family.
- Handled the full stack independently — auth (Clerk), payments (LemonSqueezy), transactional email (Resend), hosting and edge functions (Vercel), and Redis-backed state (Upstash).
- Shipped to production with a working free/paid tier model; paused active development in Feb 2026 after limited traction — distribution wasn't built into the plan, so a finished product had no real channel reaching the people it was for.

ourchapter.app — demo walkthrough available on request

SKILLS

Languages & Frameworks

JavaScript (ES6+), TypeScript, React, React Native, Next.js, Node.js, HTML5, CSS3

State & Data

Redux, Redux Toolkit, Context API, Zustand, REST APIs

Testing & Tooling

Jest, Cypress, Vite, Webpack, GitHub, GitLab, Docker (basics)

UI & Styling

Tailwind, Material UI, Bootstrap, Styled Components

Databases

PostgreSQL, MongoDB, MySQL

Practices

System Design, Performance Optimization, PCI DSS, CI/CD, Agile/Scrum, AI-assisted dev workflows (Cursor, Claude Code, local LLMs via Ollama)

EDUCATION

Statistics · Athens University of Economics and Business

2018 – 2023

Coursework completed: Python, Java, SQL, Data Analysis — did not complete degree

LANGUAGES

English (Fluent) · German (B2)

Military obligations: not yet fulfilled